

Product Requirements Document: Aether - AI Powered Second Brain

1. Project Overview

Product Name: Aether

Tagline: Your mind, expanded.

Target Audience: Aether is designed for individuals aged 16-40 who frequently experience feelings of being overwhelmed, forgetful, or scattered. This includes students, professionals, and creatives who generate numerous ideas, receive recommendations, or capture information but struggle with retaining or retrieving it effectively. The application aims to empower users to feel organized and in control of their thoughts daily, transforming their digital interactions into a seamless extension of their cognitive processes.

Core Value Proposition: Aether serves as an AI-powered second brain, meticulously designed to remember everything a user entrusts to it—ideas, conversations, recommendations, links, voice notes, and tasks. Its primary value lies in the ability for users to instantly retrieve any piece of information through natural language queries, such as "What was that restaurant Ahmed recommended?" or "What was the idea I had last Tuesday?" This capability shifts the burden of recall from the user to the intelligent system, fostering a sense of calm and enhanced productivity.

Monetization Strategy: The application will operate on a freemium model, offering a free tier with limited memory storage per month to attract and onboard users. The premium tier, priced between 99-199 EGP per month, will unlock unlimited memories and advanced AI features, catering to users who require a more robust and comprehensive memory assistant.

2. Design & Aesthetic Principles

Aether's user experience is meticulously crafted to embody a **calm, smart, minimal, and premium** aesthetic. This design philosophy is reflected across its visual elements, typography, and interactive components, aiming to create a trustworthy and intelligent environment for users.

2.1 Color Palette

The chosen color palette emphasizes tranquility and clarity, utilizing a foundation of soft, neutral tones complemented by subtle accents:

- **Primary Background:** #F8F9FA (Off-white / Alabaster) provides a clean and expansive canvas, promoting visual calm.
- **Primary Text & High-Contrast Elements:** #212529 (Deep Charcoal) ensures optimal readability and a sophisticated contrast against the light background.
- **Accent & Active States:** #6D597A (Muted Lavender) is used sparingly for subtle highlights, interactive elements, and to denote active states, adding a touch of premium elegance without being distracting.
- **Surface Elements (Cards, Containers):** #FFFFFF (Pure White) creates a sense of elevation and focus for content blocks.
- **Informational & Success States:** Soft teals and blues, such as #E0F2F1, are employed for non-intrusive feedback and positive confirmations.

2.2 Typography

Typography plays a crucial role in conveying Aether's intelligent and premium persona while ensuring optimal readability across all devices:

- **Primary Body Font:** Inter or San Francisco (System UI) will be used for all body text and general interface elements. These sans-serif fonts are selected for their exceptional readability, modern appearance, and system-level integration, contributing to a seamless user experience.
- **Heading Font:** Playfair Display (Serif) will be utilized sparingly for major headings on the landing page and key sections within the application. Its elegant serif design imparts a premium, intellectual feel, distinguishing important content.

2.3 UI Style

The user interface (UI) design of Aether adheres to principles of modern minimalism and intuitive interaction:

- **Minimalism:** The design prioritizes ample whitespace and the elimination of unnecessary visual clutter, such as excessive borders or decorative elements. This approach ensures a clean, focused environment where content takes precedence.
 - **Soft Shadows:** Depth and hierarchy are established through subtle box-shadows rather than harsh lines. This technique creates a gentle, layered effect that enhances the premium feel of the interface.
 - **Fluid Transitions:** User interactions are accompanied by fluid, slow-easing animations (0.3s - 0.5s). These subtle transitions contribute to a calm and responsive user experience, making the application feel polished and intuitive.
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3. Sitemap & Page List

The following outlines the complete sitemap and page list for the Aether web application, categorizing pages by their primary function and accessibility:

1. **Landing Page** (Public): The primary entry point for prospective users, designed to inform and convert.
 2. **Onboarding Flow** (Multi-step): A guided sequence for new users to set up their account and experience initial value.
 3. **Main Dashboard** (Authenticated): The central hub for memory management, featuring a feed and search interface.
 4. **Memory Detail View** (Authenticated): A dedicated page for viewing and interacting with individual memories.
 5. **AI Chat Interface** (Authenticated): The core natural language retrieval and interaction module.
 6. **Collections/Tags View** (Authenticated): Pages dedicated to organizing and filtering memories by categories and tags.
 7. **Daily Summary & Weekly Recap** (Authenticated): Features providing curated insights into recent memory activity.
 8. **User Profile & Settings** (Authenticated): Pages for managing user account information, preferences, and application settings.
 9. **Pricing & Subscription** (Public/Authenticated): Details on available subscription tiers and their respective features.
 10. **Payment/Checkout** (Authenticated): The secure process for subscribing to premium services.
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4. Feature Specifications

4.1 Memory Input Methods

Aether offers diverse and intuitive methods for capturing information, ensuring that users can effortlessly record thoughts and data as they arise:

- **Quick Capture:** A ubiquitous floating action button (FAB) or a global keyboard shortcut will provide instant access to the capture modal from any screen. This prioritizes speed and minimizes friction for recording fleeting thoughts.
- **Text Input:** A rich text editor will support Markdown formatting, allowing users to structure their notes with headings, lists, and other stylistic elements. This ensures

flexibility for detailed textual memories.

- **Voice Note:** Users can record voice notes directly within the app. This feature will include real-time transcription, converting spoken words into text, and leveraging AI for immediate summarization and extraction of key action items. This transforms ephemeral conversations into actionable insights.
- **Link Saving:** When a URL is pasted, Aether will automatically scrape relevant metadata, including the title, description, and a representative image. Furthermore, AI will generate a concise summary of the linked content, providing immediate context and saving users time.
- **Image/OCR:** The application will support uploading images, such as receipts, whiteboard notes, or document scans. Optical Character Recognition (OCR) technology will automatically extract text from these images, making them searchable and indexable within the user's memory database.

4.2 AI Search & Retrieval (The "Wow" Moment)

The cornerstone of Aether's value proposition is its advanced AI search and retrieval system, designed to deliver a "wow" moment with every query:

- **Natural Language Querying:** Users can interact with Aether using conversational language, posing questions like "What was the book Sarah mentioned last month?" or "Where did I save that recipe for pasta?" The system is engineered to understand intent rather than requiring precise keywords.
- **Semantic Search:** Beyond keyword matching, Aether employs semantic search capabilities to find memories based on their underlying meaning and context. This ensures that even vaguely remembered information can be accurately retrieved.
- **Contextual Answers:** Instead of merely presenting a list of potentially relevant memories, the AI will synthesize information from stored data to provide direct, concise answers to user queries. This transforms retrieval into a conversational experience, akin to asking a knowledgeable assistant.

4.3 Daily Summary & Weekly Recap

To reinforce the value of continuous memory capture and provide actionable insights, Aether incorporates intelligent summary features:

- **Daily Summary:** Users will receive a "Morning Brief" notification, either in-app or via push notification, highlighting 3-5 key items saved the previous day or tasks scheduled for the current day. This proactive summary helps users start their day informed and organized.

- **Weekly Recap:** A comprehensive weekly report will be delivered via email and accessible within the app. This recap will highlight emerging themes from captured memories, identify the most frequently used categories, and feature a "Memory Lane" section that resurfaces relevant older memories, fostering reflection and deeper engagement.
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5. Detailed Page Requirements

5.1 Landing Page

The landing page is the initial touchpoint for potential users, designed to articulate Aether's value proposition compellingly and guide visitors towards conversion. It will feature:

- **Hero Section:** This prominent section will include a compelling headline such as "Forget forgetting." and a clear sub-headline: "Aether is your AI-powered second brain. It remembers everything—so you don't have to." A primary Call-to-Action (CTA) button, "Start Your Free Brain," will be prominently displayed, alongside a secondary CTA like "Watch it in action." Visually, this section will feature a minimalist 3D abstract representation of a glowing "core" or a clean, aspirational screenshot of the retrieval interface, conveying intelligence and simplicity.
- **Features Grid:** A grid of 4-6 concise cards will highlight Aether's core benefits, such as "Voice to Wisdom," "Instant Retrieval," "Smart Categorization," and "Privacy First." Each card will feature an icon and a brief description.
- **How It Works Section:** This section will visually explain the user journey in three simple steps: 1) Capture (Text, Voice, Image), 2) Aether Indexes (AI processing), and 3) Recall (Ask in natural language). This demystifies the technology and clarifies the user's interaction model.
- **Testimonials:** Authentic, quote-based testimonials from diverse user archetypes (e.g., Creative Director, PhD Student, Startup Founder) will build trust and social proof. These will be presented in a clean, minimalist card format.
- **Pricing Preview:** A concise, side-by-side comparison of the Free vs. Premium tiers will be included, highlighting key differentiators to encourage consideration of the premium offering.
- **Footer:** The footer will contain essential links to Privacy Policy, Terms of Service, a Blog, and social media channels, ensuring transparency and accessibility to further information.

5.2 Onboarding Flow

The onboarding process is designed to be intuitive and engaging, quickly demonstrating Aether's value and guiding new users through initial setup:

- **Step 1: Welcome & Value Proposition:** A series of 3-4 swipeable introductory cards will visually explain Aether's core "wow" moments and benefits, setting expectations and building excitement.
- **Step 2: Account Creation:** Users will be prompted to create an account using email/password or convenient social authentication options (Google/Apple), ensuring a low-friction entry.
- **Step 3: Personalization:** A brief series of 3 quick questions (e.g., "What do you want to remember most? Work, Ideas, Personal Life?") will help tailor the initial experience and AI models to individual user needs.
- **Step 4: The First Memory:** To immediately demonstrate functionality, users will be guided through a mandatory "First Capture" prompt. This could involve a suggestion like: "Try it now: Say 'Remind me to check out that new cafe in Zamalek' or paste a link." This hands-on experience solidifies understanding.
- **Step 5: Permissions:** Users will be prompted to grant necessary permissions, such as microphone access for voice notes and notification permissions for reminders, with clear explanations of why these are required.

5.3 Main Dashboard

The Main Dashboard serves as the user's central command center for Aether, designed for efficient memory management and retrieval:

- **Header:** A minimalist search bar will be prominently featured at the top, pre-filled with a guiding prompt such as "What would you like to remember?" This encourages immediate interaction and reinforces the app's core function.
 - **Navigation:** On desktop, a persistent sidebar will provide access to key sections: Home (Feed), Ask Aether (Chat), Collections (Tags/Categories), Recaps (Daily/Weekly), and Settings. On mobile, this will transform into an intuitive bottom navigation bar to optimize for one-handed use and screen real estate.
 - **The Feed:** The central area of the dashboard will display a chronological feed of all captured memories. Each memory will be presented as a card, featuring a distinct icon indicating its type (voice, link, text), a concise snippet of its content, and automatically generated tags for quick contextualization.
 - **Quick Action Button:** A large, central "+" button will be strategically placed for easy access, especially on mobile. Tapping this button will open a modal offering immediate options for Voice, Text, or Photo capture, reinforcing the ease of input.
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6. Organization & Systems

Aether provides robust organizational tools, enhanced by AI, to ensure memories are not only captured but also intelligently structured and easily accessible.

6.1 Memory Categories & Tagging

Effective categorization and tagging are crucial for long-term memory management:

- **Auto-Tagging:** Leveraging advanced AI, Aether will automatically assign 2-3 relevant tags to each captured memory (e.g., #Travel, #Work, #Idea, #Recipe). This reduces manual effort and ensures consistent categorization.
- **Manual Collections:** Users will have the flexibility to create custom "Folders" or "Collections" for specific projects, themes, or areas of interest. This allows for personalized organization alongside AI-driven tagging.
- **Smart Filters:** A comprehensive filtering system will enable users to quickly narrow down their memories by date range, memory type (text, voice, link, image), or even sentiment (positive/negative/neutral), providing powerful retrieval capabilities.

6.2 Reminders & Follow-ups

Aether extends beyond passive storage by offering proactive reminder and follow-up functionalities:

- **Natural Language Reminders:** Users can set reminders directly within a memory using natural language, such as "Remind me about this next Monday" or "Follow up on this idea in two weeks." The AI will interpret these commands and schedule appropriate notifications.
- **Task Extraction:** The AI will intelligently identify potential tasks embedded within notes or voice recordings and automatically add them to a dedicated "To-Do" view. This transforms unstructured information into actionable items.
- **Gentle Nudges:** The system will provide push notifications for unfinished tasks, important ideas that haven't been revisited, or relevant memories from the past, ensuring that valuable information is not forgotten.

7. Monetization and Subscription Strategy

The Aether monetization model is strategically designed to lower the barrier to entry while simultaneously providing substantial value for power users. This tiered approach caters to a broad spectrum of users, from those seeking a basic digital catch-all to professionals

requiring a comprehensive memory infrastructure. The pricing is tailored for the Egyptian market, reflecting local economic considerations.

Feature	Free Tier (Seed)	Premium Tier (Bloom)
Price	0 EGP / Month	99 - 199 EGP / Month
Memory Limit	50 memories per month	Unlimited memories
Voice Notes	Basic transcription	Advanced AI summarization & action items
Search	Keyword-based search	Full Semantic & Natural Language Retrieval
Recaps	Monthly summary	Daily, Weekly, and Monthly detailed reports
File Storage	100 MB total	10 GB total
Sharing	View-only access	Collaborative memory sharing

7.1 Payment and Checkout Flow

The checkout experience will be designed to maintain Aether's "calm and premium" aesthetic, ensuring a seamless and trustworthy transaction process. A three-step streamlined process will be implemented:

- Plan Selection:** Users will be presented with a clear comparison table, prominently highlighting the benefits and features of the "Bloom" premium tier to facilitate an informed decision.
- Payment Method:** Secure integration with major payment gateways such as Stripe will be provided, alongside local payment providers like Fawry or Paymob to cater specifically to the Egyptian market. This will support various payment options, including credit cards and popular digital wallets.
- Success State:** Upon successful payment, a celebratory yet minimal confirmation screen will be displayed. Crucially, premium features will be unlocked instantly without requiring a page refresh or re-login, providing immediate gratification and a smooth transition to the enhanced experience.

8. User Experience States and Responsiveness

8.1 System States

To ensure a consistently robust and user-friendly experience, Aether meticulously handles various system states, providing clear visual cues and helpful guidance to prevent user frustration:

- **Empty State:** When a section or the entire memory feed is empty, a minimalist illustration with soft colors will be displayed. This will be accompanied by encouraging text, such as "Your second brain is ready. Start by whispering a thought," guiding new users on how to initiate interaction.
- **Loading State:** To mitigate perceived lag, skeleton screens that mimic the final layout of the content will be used during loading. This provides immediate visual feedback and indicates that content is on its way, enhancing the perception of responsiveness.
- **Error State:** In instances of errors, non-alarming and polite messaging will be presented (e.g., "Aether is taking a breather. Please try again in a moment."). This will include a "Retry" button and, where applicable, a prompt to check internet connectivity, empowering users to resolve minor issues.
- **Offline State:** A subtle banner at the top of the interface will inform users when they are offline. The application will support offline capture, with a clear message indicating that captured memories will automatically sync once an internet connection is re-established, ensuring no data loss.

8.2 Mobile Responsiveness Requirements

Aether is conceived as a "**mobile-first**" application, recognizing that the majority of user interactions, particularly quick captures, will occur on mobile devices. Therefore, mobile responsiveness is not merely an add-on but a foundational design principle:

- **Touch Targets:** All interactive elements, including buttons and links, will adhere to a minimum touch target size of 44x44 pixels, ensuring ease of use and preventing accidental taps on smaller screens.
- **Gestures:** Intuitive mobile gestures, such as swipe-to-delete and swipe-to-archive, will be implemented for efficient management of memories within the feed, enhancing the native app feel.
- **One-Handed Use:** The critical "Quick Capture" button will be strategically positioned within the natural reach of a user's thumb (typically bottom center or bottom right) to facilitate effortless one-handed operation.
- **Adaptive Layout:** The layout will dynamically adapt across devices. For instance, the persistent sidebar present on desktop interfaces will transform into an intuitive bottom

navigation bar on mobile, maximizing screen real estate for content and maintaining navigational accessibility.

9. Technical Specifications for Developers

9.1 Core Technology Stack

Developers building Aether should leverage a modern, scalable, and robust technology stack capable of handling real-time AI processing, secure data management, and efficient retrieval:

- **Frontend:** **React.js** or **Next.js** will be utilized for building the user interface, providing a highly performant and interactive experience. **Tailwind CSS** will be employed for styling, enabling rapid development of a responsive, utility-first design that aligns with the minimal aesthetic.
- **Backend:** The backend will be developed using either **Node.js (TypeScript)** or **Python (FastAPI)**. These choices offer excellent performance for handling complex AI orchestrations, API integrations, and real-time data processing.
- **Database:** A hybrid database approach is recommended. A **relational database (PostgreSQL)** will manage structured user data, authentication, and subscription information. Concurrently, a **Vector Database (e.g., Pinecone or Weaviate)** will be essential for storing and querying memory embeddings, enabling highly efficient semantic search and natural language retrieval capabilities.
- **AI Integration:** For core AI functionalities, integration with **OpenAI GPT-4o** is paramount for advanced natural language understanding, contextual answering, and summarization. **Whisper** will be integrated for high-accuracy voice-to-text transcription, ensuring precise conversion of voice notes into searchable text.

9.2 Notification and Sharing Systems

Notification System: Aether's notification system is founded on a "push, don't pull" philosophy, designed to proactively deliver smart, contextual reminders and summaries to users. Notifications will be delivered via browser push notifications for immediate in-app alerts. Additionally, for "ultra-fast" capture and critical reminders, optional integrations with popular messaging platforms like Telegram or WhatsApp will be explored, allowing users to capture memories or receive nudges directly through these channels.

Sharing Feature: The sharing functionality will allow users to generate a "Public Memory Link" for individual memories. When shared, recipients will access a beautifully formatted, read-only web page displaying the memory (e.g., a curated list of recommendations, a summarized meeting transcript). For premium users, the ability to invite collaborators to

"Shared Collections" will be provided, fostering a collective second brain environment for teams, families, or study groups, enabling shared knowledge and collaborative memory management.

10. The "Wow" Moment: Retrieval Speed of Thought

The ultimate success metric and defining characteristic of Aether is the **Retrieval Speed of Thought**. This refers to the application's ability to instantly and accurately retrieve information based on a user's natural language query, often synthesizing multiple pieces of data into a coherent answer. The "wow" moment occurs when a user asks a question like, "What was that Egyptian startup idea I had last Tuesday?" and the system doesn't just return a list of notes, but a synthesized, contextual answer: *"You were thinking about a 'Fintech for Artisans' platform while walking in Maadi. You noted that the key differentiator would be the micro-lending integration."* This synthesis of time, location, and content, delivered with conversational fluency, elevates Aether from a mere note-taking application to a true, intelligent second brain, making the user feel understood and empowered.

11. References

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